Class 10 SST - Chapter 9: Agriculture

🌟 Introduction to the Chapter

India is an agriculturally important country. Two-thirds of its population is engaged in agricultural activities. Agriculture is a primary activity, which produces most of the food that we consume. Besides food grains, it also produces raw material for various industries.

📌 Types of Farming

1. Primitive Subsistence Farming

- This type of farming is still practiced in a few pockets of India.
- It is practiced on small patches of land with the help of primitive tools like hoe, dao, and digging sticks, and family/community labor.
- It is a **'slash and burn'** agriculture where farmers clear a patch of land and produce cereals to sustain their family.

2. Intensive Subsistence Farming

- Practiced in areas of high population pressure on land.
- It is labor-intensive farming, where high doses of biochemical inputs and irrigation are used for obtaining higher production.

3. Commercial Farming

- The main characteristic is the use of higher doses of modern inputs, e.g., High Yielding Variety (HYV) seeds, chemical fertilizers, insecticides and pesticides in order to obtain higher productivity.
- **Plantation:** A type of commercial farming where a single crop is grown on a large area (e.g., Tea in Assam, Coffee in Karnataka).

⚡ Cropping Pattern

India has three distinct agricultural seasons:

1. **Rabi:** Sown in winter from October to December and harvested in summer from April to June. Important crops: Wheat, barley, peas, gram, and mustard.
2. **Kharif:** Sown with the onset of monsoon in different parts of the country and harvested in September-October. Important crops: Paddy, maize, jowar, bajra, tur (arhar), moong, urad, cotton, jute, groundnut, and soybean.
3. **Zaid:** In between the rabi and kharif seasons, there is a short season during the summer months known as the Zaid season. Important crops: Watermelon, muskmelon, cucumber, vegetables, and fodder crops.

❌ Common Mistakes to Avoid

> [!WARNING]
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> 1. **Kharif vs Rabi:** It is very common to mix these up. Remember that Kharif crops (like Rice) need lots of water and are sown in the Monsoon. Rabi crops (like Wheat) are winter crops.
> 2. **Gross Cropped Area vs Net Sown Area:** Net Sown Area is the physical land sown with crops. Gross Cropped Area counts land mathematically if it is sown more than once in an agricultural year!

📝 Quick Revision

Major Crops Overview

- **Rice:** Our staple food crop. Kharif crop. Requires high temperature (above 25°C) and high humidity with annual rainfall above 100 cm.
- **Wheat:** The second most important cereal crop. Rabi crop. Requires a cool growing season and bright sunshine at the time of ripening. Requires 50 to 75 cm of annual rainfall.
- **Millets:** Jowar, bajra, and ragi are the important millets grown in India. Known as coarse grains, they have very high nutritional value.
- **Cash Crops:** Sugarcane (requires hot and humid climate), Oilseeds, Tea (plantation crop, requires a warm and moist frost-free climate), Coffee, Rubber.